Final Course Project Instructions

Submission deadline: August 2, 2026 (2.8.2026) | Project grade weight: 85%

Project Overview

As part of the course requirements, each student must complete a final project on data analysis, based on one of the topics listed in the course project topics link.

The project should use relevant datasets, investigate them carefully, identify meaningful and interesting patterns, and present the findings clearly through high-quality visualizations.

The final project constitutes 85% of the course grade.

Project Requirements

- The project is individual. Since there is no home exam this year, projects may not be submitted in groups.
- The submission must include both a short research paper and code.
  - The paper must be written in English, in a two-column format, and may be up to 5 pages long, not including the bibliography.
  - The project code must be submitted through GitHub, preferably with a Colab notebook that presents the findings of the work. If the notebook uses additional code files, those files should also be included.
  - The GitHub repository must remain private until the course staff confirms that it is acceptable to make it public. The repository should be shared with the course staff for evaluation. Do not publish the repository publicly before receiving approval.
  - After approval, the code may be made public under an open-source license, unless this is restricted by privacy, data-use agreements, intellectual property restrictions, or approval from a co-supervisor.
  - If the project has a co-supervisor, the student must receive the co-supervisor's approval before publishing the code or any project materials.

Privacy, Security, and Responsible Publication

- Do not upload private information, confidential data, personal data, API keys, passwords, tokens, credentials, private URLs, or any other secrets to GitHub, Colab, the paper, or the submitted files.
- Use environment variables, configuration templates, .gitignore files, and secret-management practices to avoid exposing private information or keys.
- If your project uses sensitive or restricted data, include only anonymized, aggregated, or permitted examples in the submitted repository and paper.

Important Dates

- Deadline for final submission: August 2, 2026 (2.8.2026).

Academic Integrity and Use of Tools

- Do not copy, reuse, or lightly modify projects created by other people, including data-analysis projects published on Kaggle or similar platforms.
- You may use ChatGPT, other LLMs, coding assistants, or any other tools. However, you must clearly acknowledge all tools used in the Acknowledgment section of the paper.
- The project must reflect your own understanding, analysis, and contribution.

Clarification and Oral Examination

- If the project, methodology, code, results, contribution, or the student's individual understanding is unclear, the course staff may require an oral examination.
- In such cases, the final grade may be determined, in whole or in part, with the help of the oral examination.

Evaluation Criteria

The project grade will be determined according to the following criteria:

- The novelty and originality of the research question, analysis, and results.
- The level and quality of the data processing, analysis, and presentation. Preference will be given to projects that combine and analyze data from multiple relevant sources.
- The clarity and accessibility of the research for other people and researchers.
- The quality, organization, reproducibility, and accessibility of the submitted code and, when approved, the published code.
- The relative quality of the project compared with other projects in the course.

Good luck!